

Review of crash near National faults FAA

NTSB emphasizes role of systemic failures, says collision was preventable

BY RACHEL WEINER, LORI ARATANI AND TARA COPP

The Federal Aviation Administration is continuing to ignore warnings about close calls between aircraft a year after a deadly collision above Reagan National Airport between a commercial jet and a U.S. Army helicopter, the head of the National Transportation Safety Board said Tuesday.

“Are there other hot spots? And am I concerned that the FAA is not paying attention to those other hot spots? The answer to that is yes,” Jennifer Homendy told reporters during a break in a hearing on the crash that killed 67 people.

Investigators found in their nearly year-long review of the tragedy that it was “100 percent preventable,” Homendy said. Air traffic controllers were routinely overwhelmed and probably desensitized to the number of near misses at the airport, investigators concluded, while pilots were left to manage visual separation from other aircraft on their own, without being told how narrow their flight paths were. And controllers and pilots who flagged the situation as dangerous went unheeded, they said.

“We have an entire tower who took it upon themselves to try to raise concerns over and over, and over and over again, only to get squashed, by management and

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Scan and destroy: The race to train AI

Anthropic aimed to ‘destructively scan all the books in the world’

BY AARON SCHAFER, WILL OREMUS AND NITASHA TIKU

In early 2024, executives at artificial intelligence start-up Anthropic ramped up an ambitious project they sought to keep quiet. “Project Panama is our effort to destructively scan all the books in the world,” an internal planning document unsealed in legal filings last week said. “We don’t want it to be known that we are working on this.”

Within about a year, according to the filings, the company had spent tens of millions of dollars to acquire and slice the spines off millions of books, before scanning their pages to feed more knowledge into the AI models behind products such as its popular chatbot, Claude.

Details of Project Panama, which have not been previously reported, emerged in more than 4,000 pages of documents in a copyright lawsuit brought by book authors against Anthropic, which has been valued by investors at \$183 billion. The company

SEE AI ON A8



ROBERTO SCHMIDT/AFP/GETTY IMAGES

Anti-ICE protesters rally Tuesday outside the office of Minnesota Gov. Tim Walz (D) in St. Paul. Tuesday's statement from the Department of Homeland Security said that as agents attempted to take Alex Pretti into custody, he resisted, and “a struggle ensued.”

White House called shootings justified before facts were in

BY DAVID NAKAMURA AND OLIVIA GEORGE

Department of Homeland Security officers have fired shots during enforcement arrests or at people protesting their operations 16 times since July, and as in the recent shootings in Minneapolis, in each case the Trump administration has publicly declared their actions justified before waiting for investigations to be completed.

Most of the incidents involve officers firing at drivers during enforcement stops in cities like Los Angeles and Chicago where DHS has surged federal immigration officers. At least 10 people have been struck by bullets — including four U.S. citizens. Three people have been killed.

The shootings have sparked alarm not only for their violence but also for the Trump administration's response. Lawyers say officials have been quick to pursue felony charges against those fired at — though in four of 10 cases, prosecutors have either dropped charges or a judge has dismissed them after evidence emerged contradicting the government's narrative of events.

None of the officers from Immigration and Customs Enforcement, U.S. Border Patrol or Homeland Security Investigations has faced criminal charges in any of the shootings, nor has the administration announced any internal disciplinary measures against them.

“Historically, federal cases are

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Threatening contempt, judge orders ICE chief to appear

BY JEREMY ROEBUCK

Minnesota's chief federal judge has demanded the acting head of U.S. Immigration and Customs Enforcement personally appear in court Friday, threatening to hold him in contempt for what the judge described as repeated defiance of court orders amid the agency's enforcement efforts in the state.

“The court's patience is at an end,” U.S. District Judge Patrick J. Schiltz wrote in a remarkable filing late Monday, summoning acting ICE director Todd M. Lyons to his courtroom. Schiltz cited several instances in which ICE failed to grant detained immigrants bond hearings that had been ordered by the courts.

Schiltz's order amounted to an

extraordinary public cry of frustration from a federal judiciary that has been inundated with pleas from detained migrants and government attempts to charge protesters as thousands of agents have surged into Minnesota as part of the Trump administration's largest immigration crackdown to date.

It also threatened to set up another showdown between the federal courts and administration officials, who have sought to paint judges who question their tactics as “liberal activists” and have in some instances called for the judges' impeachments.

“The Court acknowledges that ordering the head of a federal agency to personally appear is an extraordinary step,” wrote Schiltz,

SEE COURT ON A6

DHS: 2 agents fired at Pretti

NO MENTION OF BRANDISHING A GUN

Homan takes over as anger builds in Minn.

This article is by Annie Gowen, Kadia Goba, Matt Viser, Ben Brasch and Joanna Slater

MINNEAPOLIS — Two Border Patrol agents fired at Alex Pretti during Saturday's fatal shooting in Minneapolis, according to a statement sent to some members of Congress by the Department of Homeland Security that provides the first official timeline of the deadly encounter that has sent shock waves across the country.

The statement, based on a preliminary review, makes no mention of Pretti brandishing a weapon. That contradicts administration comments in the immediate aftermath of the confrontation, when senior officials described the 37-year-old as a direct threat to federal officers.

Gregory Bovino, the Border Patrol commander then overseeing the Minneapolis operation, suggested that Pretti had wanted to “massacre” officers, while Homeland Security Secretary Kristi L. Noem said he had “committed an act of domestic terrorism.”

Tuesday's statement said that as agents attempted to take Pretti into custody, he resisted and “a struggle ensued.” One agent yelled multiple times that Pretti had a gun, and then two agents fired their weapons. Pretti was shot repeatedly and declared dead half an hour later at Hennepin County Medical Center, the statement noted.

By Tuesday, the Trump administration was backing away from some of its inflammatory rhetoric about the shooting and had re-

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Turning a tragedy into a teachable moment

40 years after Challenger disaster, those involved with shuttle mission feel obligated to share painful lessons



BRUCE WEAVER/AP

Challenger launches from Cape Canaveral, Florida, on Jan. 28, 1986. The space shuttle exploded 73 seconds into its flight, killing all seven aboard, including high school teacher Christa McAuliffe.

BY MICHAEL KRANISH

As high school teacher Christa McAuliffe prepared to be strapped into the space shuttle Challenger, Brian Russell, an official at the company that built the craft's solid rocket boosters, had just participated in a fateful teleconference from his Utah headquarters.

Like every other engineer in the conference room at Morton Thiokol on that day four decades ago, the 31-year-old Russell opposed launching because the bitterly cold temperature at Florida's Kennedy Space Center threatened the O-rings that sealed the rocket boosters. Their managers initially supported this view, but Russell listened in dismay as they reversed themselves under pressure from NASA officials and senior company officials and signed off on the launch.

The mission ended in catastrophe for the reason that Russell feared — a story I know well as a reporter who covered McAuliffe

and witnessed the Challenger's explosion. But for those involved in this tragedy, the families of the astronauts and those who approved the launch, much about this story is perhaps even more relevant today than it was on Jan. 28, 1986.

The belief that there are still lessons to learn from the disaster is what led Russell last year to take an extraordinary step that, until now, has received no public notice. He visited NASA centers across the country, telling the Challenger story in hopes that similar mistakes will not occur as the space agency prepares to launch four astronauts on Artemis II, which is scheduled to fly by the moon as soon as February.

The lesson of Challenger is not just about the O-rings that failed. For Russell and colleagues who accompanied him on the NASA tour, understanding the human causes behind the Challenger disaster provides still-crucial lessons about managers who fail to

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